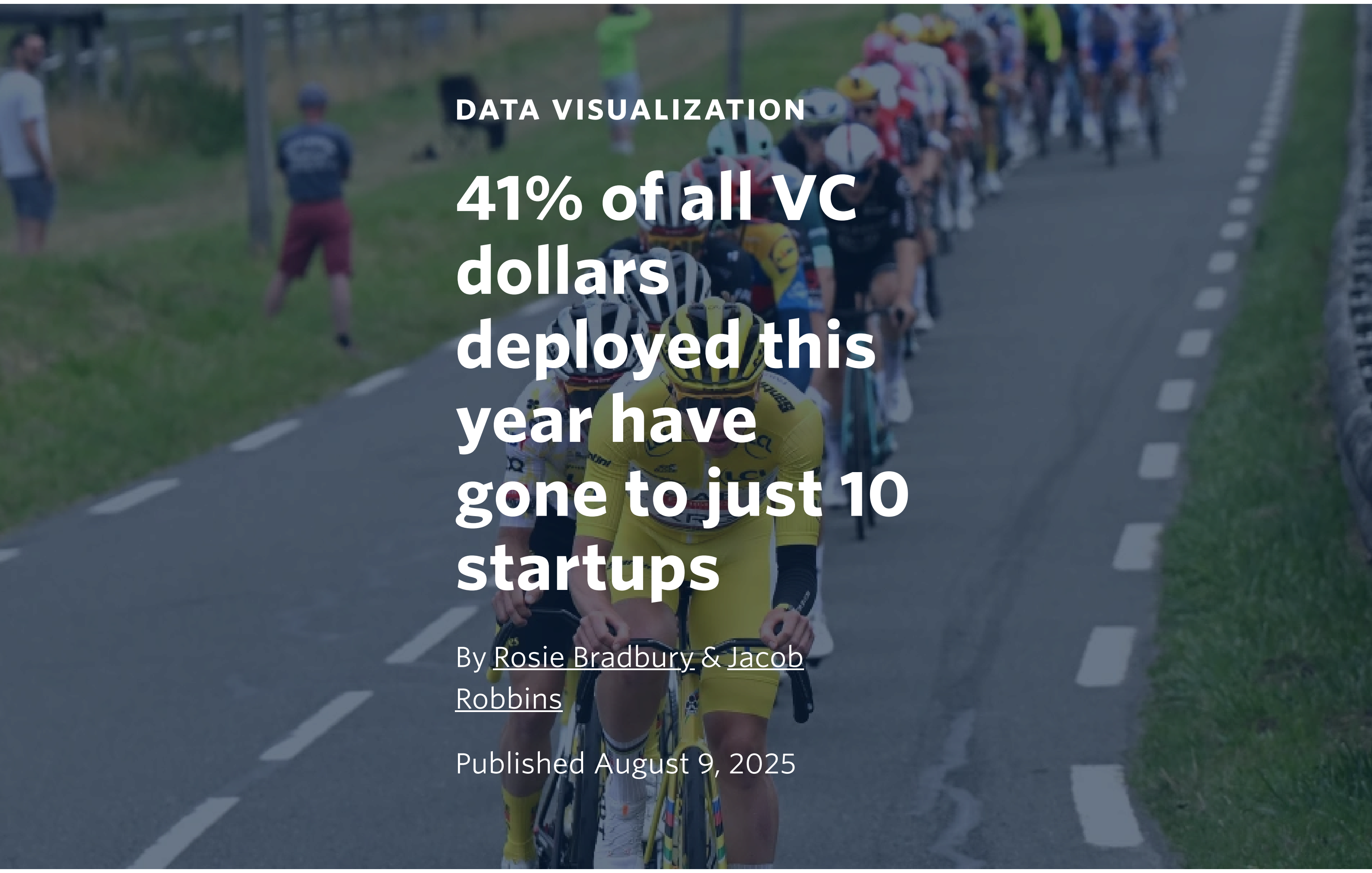

DATA VISUALIZATION

41% of all VC dollars deployed this year have gone to just 10 startups

By Rosie Bradbury & Jacob Robbins

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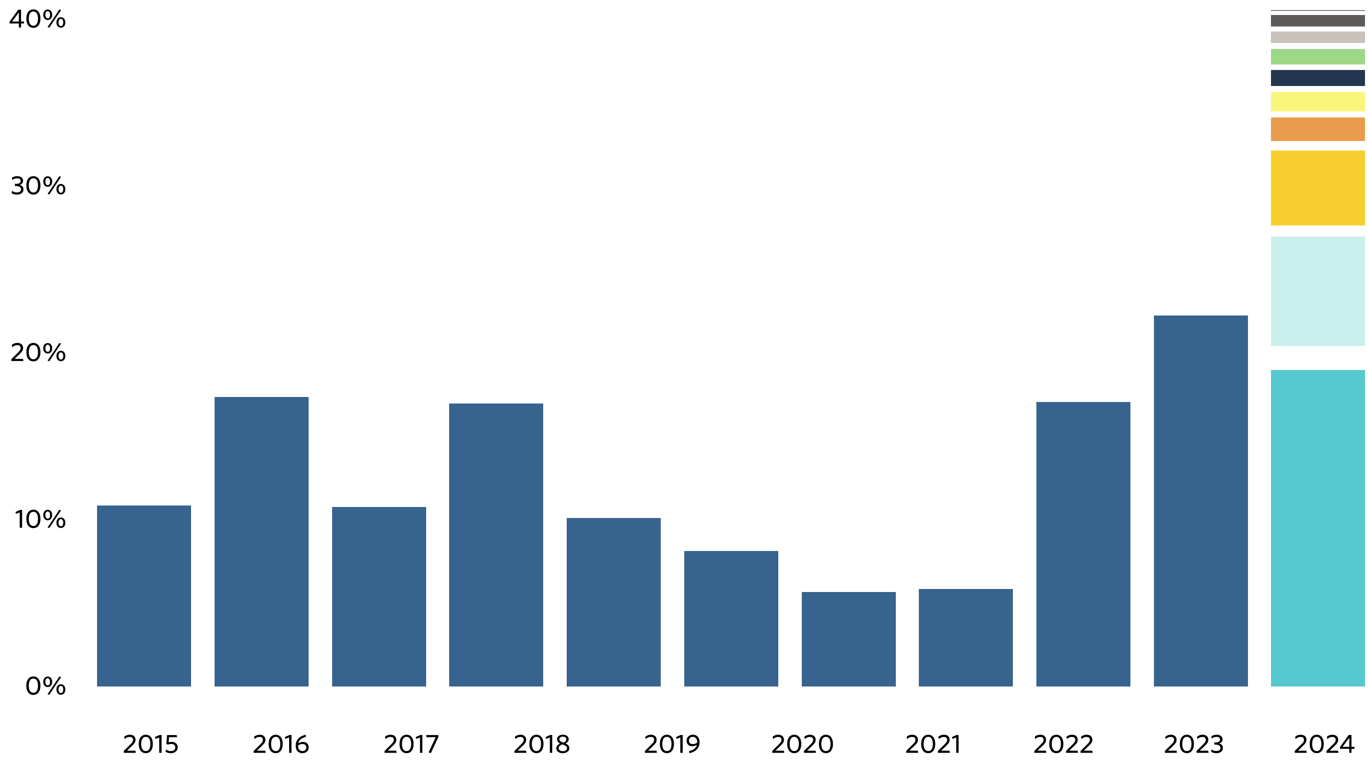
VC dollars are pouring into the hottest AI companies at such a clip it would make even Adam Neumann nervous.

So far this year, 41% of all VC dollars allocated in the US have gone to just 10 companies—a 75% increase from the share awarded to the top 10 companies in 2024 and a greater share than any year in the last decade.

Concentrated capital

Share of total venture capital in top 10 deals



Source: PitchBook • Geography: US• As of Aug. 7, 2025

The top 10 startups by capital raised, eight of which are AI companies, have secured $81.3 billion in 2025. In total, VCs have invested $197.2 billion in capital this year.

OpenAI alone raised $40 billion, the largest single financing event in the VC industry's history. xAI and Anthropic took silver and bronze, having raised a collective $20 billion.

Capital naturally concentrates in top-performing companies due to the power law—the idea that one big win can offset many failed bets.

But, when taken to an extreme, it can reduce diversification and participation in the asset class.

“Markets are way more winner-take-all than they’ve ever been before,” said Brandon Gleklen, a principal at Battery Ventures. “I think as a result, you’re seeing more investors say, ‘Hey, if I am not in the winner, then yeah, I shouldn’t be in the game to begin with.’”

Blue-chip VCs have coalesced around a handful of AI companies that they expect to win big. However, should several of these companies fall short of their vaulted valuations, the follow-on effects for LPs could be severe for those with concentrated positions.

“It’s a very dangerous thing,” said Anna Barber, partner at M13. “Where there’s a lot of consensus and massive amounts of agreement, it’s so much harder to invest a stake in a good position.”

And another downstream effect of the capital concentration is a more competitive landscape where investors find themselves furiously trying to still back winners in the AI horse race.

“FOMO is a terrible way to invest,” said Jane Alexander, partner at CapitalG. “You don’t want people to be throwing term sheets after two weeks, that’s bad for the company and bad for investors who may really not understand the business they’re backing.”

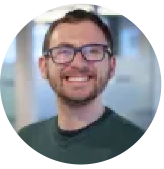
And with capital getting increasingly concentrated, some say it suggests a changing attitude within the VC landscape.

“I think if you’re in venture and you wake up every morning saying I want to pile into the same 10 companies as everyone else, I just think that’s fundamentally unambitious,” Gleklen said. “It feels like venture has changed to consensus ideas and who has access. That just doesn’t excite me.”

Featured image by Dario Belingheri/Getty Images

About Rosie Bradbury

Rosie Bradbury is a senior reporter covering startups and venture capital for PitchBook News. Based in New York, she previously reported for the Bureau of Investigative Journalism, Business Insider and Wired. Rosie studied history and politics at the University of Cambridge.



About Jacob Robbins

Reporter Jacob Robbins covers artificial intelligence and the venture capital ecosystem for PitchBook. Based in Seattle, Jacob is originally from Massachusetts and holds dual degrees in political science and cinema studies from the American University. His work has previously appeared in Air Mail and Business Insider.

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